Fraction Explorer

TEACHER KEY

5th Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Build two fractions with fraction bars, find equivalent fractions and a common denominator, and compare, add or subtract them. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Show $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{1}{3}$. What is the least common denominator?

6

2. Find $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3}$.

$\frac{5}{6}$

3. Find $\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{6}$.

$\frac{7}{12}$

4. Which is greater: $\frac{3}{5}$ or $\frac{5}{8}$?

$\frac{5}{8}$ ($\frac{24}{40} < \frac{25}{40}$)

5. Find two different fractions that are equivalent to $\frac{2}{3}$.

Examples: $\frac{4}{6}$, $\frac{6}{9}$, $\frac{8}{12}$

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Explore more

6. Find $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{3}{4}$. Write the answer as a mixed number.

$1\frac{5}{12}$

7. Explain why $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3}$ is not $\frac{2}{5}$.

$\frac{2}{5}$ is less than $\frac{1}{2}$, but adding $\frac{1}{3}$ must make the sum bigger than $\frac{1}{2}$.

Reflect

8. Reflect: Why do we need a common denominator?

So that we are adding parts of the same size.

Teacher notes

Accept equivalent forms (for example 1/2 = 2/4 = 0.5) and any correct example where several answers are possible. Have students explain using the tool's picture.